

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1989-09-26

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

dear b ahá'í friends,

The international Teaching center has recently asked the universal house of justice about the possibility of direct involvement of Auxiliary board members and their assistants in encouraging the holding of Nineteen day feasts in communities where the local Spiritual Assembly is not exercising its responsibilities in this regard. The house of justice responded as follows.

As you rightly point out, in many such communities the fostering of the feast is an effective aid to community development. feasts may, in turn, lead to other activities such as children's classes, and gradually help in the activation of the local Assembly. Assistants may therefore assume the important role of encouraging the believers to gather for the feast as an interim measure when the local Spiritual Assembly is not functioning, although the Nineteen day feast can be an official administrative occasion only when there is a local Spiritual Assembly to take charge of it. indeed groups, spontaneous gatherings of the friends, and even isolated believers may certainly observe the feast. it should nevertheless be borne in mind that the goal is for the local Assembly to be strengthened in order that it may itself assume responsibility to conduct the feast.

it would be appropriate for you to consult with the counselors about the matter. The Auxiliary board members and their assistants can do a great deal to assist.

with loving b ahá'í greetings,

Department of the secretariat^{73.1}

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Passing of Roddy Lutchmaya, Continental Counselor

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]